



Photo shows the style reference for the activity cube, not the finished crocheted product.

LME CROCHET PATTERN - BABY

PIP'S ACTIVITY TOY

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A soft activity cube, approx. 11 to 12 cm per side, full of things to explore on each of the six sides: Pip himself with his spike stripe and a sage green ruffled collar, a smiling star, a detail side with a heart, a leaf, a small mirror and a cloud, a large baby-safe mirror in a sage green scalloped frame, Pip peeking out of a little pocket, and a crinkle side with a cloud that crinkles when you squeeze it. Two wooden corner rings and a bead trim along the top complete the cube.

By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



IMPORTANT: This toy has many small parts. Read the whole safety page carefully before you start, and sew absolutely everything on with tight, double stitching.

ABOUT PIP'S ACTIVITY TOY

PART OF PIP'S WORLD

Pip's activity toy belongs to the LME Baby Collection "Woodland Dreams". The cube gathers Pip's whole world across six small sides: Pip himself with his spike stripe, the smiling star, the detail side with little things from the forest floor, the mirror where the child meets their own reflection, the pocket where Pip peeks out, and the cloud that crinkles on the crinkle side.

STYLE AND SENSES

Scandinavian and Montessori-inspired, in the same natural colours as the rest of the collection. Each side has its own task to explore, from recognising shapes and motifs to hearing a little cloud crinkle, exactly the kind of sensory, hands-on play the Montessori philosophy is built on.

MOST IMPORTANT OF ALL: SAFETY

This toy has more small parts than any other pattern in the collection, and also includes a small mirror, two wooden rings and a crinkle sheet. Everything must be sewn on with double strength, and page 19 is entirely dedicated to safety. Read that page carefully before you begin.

MATERIALS AND YARN ALTERNATIVES

YARN

Bystrikk Merino in cream (the cube sides) and light brown (the edging colour), plus dark warm brown for Pip's spike stripe and ears, and leftover sage green, powder pink, yellow and light sky blue for the motifs, the same yarn family as the rest of the Pip collection.

Alternative yarn: any soft cotton-blend DK-weight yarn works well, for example DROPS Safran or Hobbii Amigo.

TOOLS AND SUPPLIES

- Heklenål 3 eller 3,5 mm
- Seks tynne skumkvadrater eller stiv filtplate, ca. 10 x 10 cm · BPA-fri, til å gi kubens form, skal alltid være helt innsydd
- Polyesterfiber til fyll · til hjørner/kanter og til Pip-motivene
- Babysikkert speil (akryl/plast, ikke glass) · liten, rund speilplate beregnet for babyprodukter, se side om speilet
- To treteetheringer · umalt/BPA-fri, CE-merket, beregnet for barn, til hjørnene
- Runde treperler i noen få størrelser · BPA-frie, til topphåndtaket og hjørneduskene
- Knitrefolie beregnet for babyprodukter (liten bit) · til knitresiden, se side om knitresiden
- Stoppenål med butt spiss og tvinnet bomullstråd · til all somming
- Saks og målebånd

DIFFICULTY, SIZE AND GAUGE

DIFFICULTY

Medium to challenging: many small parts, six panels that must all match in size, and a technique new to the collection, sewing the panels together into a three-dimensional cube. A good pattern once you have crocheted at least one of the other Pip patterns first.

FINISHED SIZE

The cube is approx. 11 to 12 cm per side, depending on your gauge and the thickness of the inner stiffening.

GAUGE

Crochet tightly, amigurumi tension: approx. 20 sc x 22 rows = 10 x 10 cm on a 3 mm hook.

ABBREVIATIONS (NORWEGIAN AND US)

Here are all the abbreviations used in this pattern, including the loop stitch for the spike stripe, with the common US crochet terms alongside.

Norwegian	US	Means
lm	ch	luftmaske / chain
fm	sc	fastmaske / single crochet
halvstav	hdc	halv stav / half double crochet
stav	dc	stav / double crochet
kjm	sl st	kjedemaske / slip stitch
løkkm	loop st	løkkemaske: se Pips egen oppskrift for full forklaring
økn	inc	økning: 2 fm i samme maske
mink	dec	minking: 2 fm sammen
m	st(s)	maske(r)
...	*...*	gjenta det mellom stjernene så mange ganger som står bak

TIPS BEFORE YOU START

- Crochet all six base squares first, and check that they are exactly the same size before starting on the decorative motifs.
- Lay all the finished sides next to each other and plan which side should face which way, before sewing anything together.
- Insert the foam squares last, right before sewing the final seam closed, so the cube holds its shape without making the sewing difficult.

HOW THE ACTIVITY CUBE IS BUILT

The cube has six sides, taken from the reference photo. All six have their own motif, this cube has no plain, undecorated bottom.

1. The base squares

six matching panels with an edging colour

3. The star side

a smiling star with small stars scattered around

5. The mirror side

a large baby-safe mirror in a scalloped frame

7. The crinkle side

a cloud with crinkling material inside, that crinkles when squeezed

9. The top handle

a bead trim along the top seam

2. The Pip side

the front, with a spike stripe and a ruffled collar

4. The detail side

a heart, a leaf, a small mirror and a cloud, four motifs on one side

6. The pocket side

a miniature Pip peeking out of a pocket

8. Assembly and stiffening

the six sides sewn into a cube

10. The corner rings and tassels

two wooden rings and two bead tassels

PART 1: THE BASE SQUARES

All six sides of the cube start as the same simple square. Crochet the motifs onto them afterwards, side by side.

Chain 24 + 1 turning chain in cream. Row 1: 24 sc. Repeat row 1 (turning between each row) until the piece is square, approx. 11 x 11 cm, roughly 22 to 24 rows depending on your gauge. Fasten off. Crochet six matching squares in total.

Edge each square with one round of sc in light brown all the way around (sc evenly along the sides, 3 sc in each corner so it lies flat). Fasten off and weave in the end. This gives the light border you see around each side in the reference photo.

PART 2: THE PIP SIDE

The front of the cube is Pip himself, with a spike stripe and a little ruffled collar, the same technique as on the rattle and the stroller toy's medallion.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring, cream	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5 to 6	24 sc, 2 rounds	24
7	(2 sc, dec) x 6 - stuff very lightly	18
8	dec x 6	9

Cut, leaving a long tail. Sew on two small, two-part ears (outside in dark warm brown: 5 sc in a magic ring, fasten off, inside in cream: 4 sc in a magic ring, fasten off, sew the light circle onto the middle of the dark one, make 2) on top, and embroider a small face.

The spike stripe: chain 4 + 1 turning chain in dark warm brown, 3 rows of loop st (4 loop st each row). Cut, leaving a long tail. Sew the spike stripe on permanently and flat, along the centre line between the ears, at the top of the head.

The ruffled collar: attach sage green yarn at the bottom edge of the head. *1 sc in the next stitch, skip 1 stitch, 5 dc in the next stitch (a little fan), skip 1 stitch*, repeat all the way around the bottom edge. Fasten off. Finally, sew Pip's head securely onto the middle of the panel.

PART 3: THE STAR SIDE

A large, smiling star in powder pink, with a few tiny stars embroidered around it, just like in the reference photo.

Crochet 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18), (2 sc, inc) x 6 (24). Continue straight into the points, without joining the round: *skip 2 sts, in the next st: 1 sl st, 2 ch, 3 dc, 2 ch, 1 sl st*, repeat until you have five large points, shaped like a star. Fasten off, leaving a long tail, press flat.

Embroider a small, smiling face in the middle of the star (two closed eyes with lashes, a little mouth and pink cheeks), and a few tiny five-pointed stars scattered around it on the panel in a contrasting colour, just like in the reference photo. Sew the finished star securely onto the middle of the panel.

PART 4: THE DETAIL SIDE

Four small motifs share one single panel, one in each corner: a heart, a leaf, a small mirror and a cloud, just like in the reference photo.

THE HEART (POWDER PINK)

Crochet two matching halves: 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), fasten off (make 2). Sew the two halves together along a straight edge at the top, and gently press them down towards a point at the bottom, into a heart shape. Press flat and sew onto the top of one corner.

THE LEAF (SAGE GREEN)

Chain 7. Starting in the 2nd ch from the hook: 1 sl st, 1 sc, 1 hdc, 2 dc in the last ch (the tip), turn and continue along the other side of the chain: 1 hdc, 1 sc, 1 sl st. Fasten off, leaving a long tail. Sew onto the other top corner.

THE SMALL MIRROR (YELLOW)

Crochet two matching circles in cream, a little bigger than a small mirror piece: 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18). Place a small, round mirror piece between the two circles, and sew them together around the entire edge with very tight stitches. Attach yellow yarn around the edge and crochet a simple scalloped edge (*1 sc, skip 1 st, 2 dc in the next st*, repeat around). Sew onto the bottom of one corner.

THE SMALL CLOUD (CREAM/LIGHT SKY BLUE)

Crochet three overlapping circles in cream: (a) 6 sc in a magic ring. (b) 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12). (c) 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18). Overlap and sew the three circles together into a little cloud shape. Sew onto the bottom of the other corner, and feel free to embroider a small star or two in light sky blue beside it.

PART 5: THE MIRROR SIDE (BABY-SAFE)

The mirror is the only hard part in this toy, and requires extra care.

Crochet two matching circles in cream, a little bigger than the mirror disc itself: 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18), (2 sc, inc) x 6 (24). Place the mirror disc between the two circles, and sew them together around the entire edge with very tight stitches, so the mirror is fully enclosed and cannot be removed or slide out of the pocket.

The scalloped frame: attach sage green yarn directly into the outer edge of the sewn-in mirror circle, and crochet one round: 24 sc all the way around. Continue straight into the scallops, without joining the round: *skip 1 st, in the next st: 1 sl st, 2 ch, 3 dc, 2 ch, 1 sl st*, repeat until you have eight scallops all the way around the mirror, just like the scalloped edge in the reference photo. Fasten off and weave in the end. Sew the mirror with its scalloped frame securely onto the middle of the panel.

Use only a flexible, unbreakable baby-safe mirror intended for children's products, never real glass. Check that the mirror disc has no sharp edges before you insert it.

PART 6: THE POCKET SIDE

A tiny miniature Pip peeks up out of a pocket at the bottom of the panel, a little peekaboo surprise, with a small flower beside it, just like in the reference photo.

The pocket: chain 12 + 1 turning chain in sage green. Row 1: 12 sc. Repeat row 1 for 8 rows in total. Fold the piece in half and sew together along the two short sides and the bottom, so it becomes a small, open pocket. Sew the pocket's bottom edge onto the bottom of the panel, with the opening facing up.

Miniature Pip: 6 sc in a magic ring, cream (6), inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18), 1 round straight (18), dec x 6 (9), stuff very lightly. Fasten off, leaving a long tail. Sew on two tiny, two-part ears and embroider a small face, just like on the Pip side. Feel free to embroider a small flower in powder pink beside the pocket opening.

Sew the miniature Pip securely just behind the pocket opening, a little higher than the pocket itself, so that only the head pokes up out of the pocket, as if he is peeking out. Pip must be sewn completely onto the panel, not just placed loosely inside the pocket.

PART 7: THE CRINKLE SIDE

This side offers a completely different sense to explore: sound. Inside the soft cloud you place a crinkling material, a crinkle sheet intended for baby products, safely sewn completely inside the cloud, so that it crinkles right where the child squeezes it.

The cloud, front and back: crochet two matching sets of three overlapping circles in cream, the same method as the small cloud on the detail side, but one size larger: (a) 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12). (b) 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18). (c) 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18), (2 sc, inc) x 6 (24). Overlap and sew the three circles together into a cloud shape. Crochet two matching clouds in total, one for the front and one for the back of the pillow. Feel free to embroider a few tiny stars around the cloud, just like in the reference photo.

Place a small sheet of crinkling material, a crinkle sheet intended for baby products, between the two clouds, and sew them together around the entire edge with tight stitches, so the sheet is fully enclosed and cannot be removed. This is what makes the crinkle sound: when the cloud is squeezed, the crinkle sheet inside crumples and makes the crisp, crinkling sound the child will discover. Sew the finished, filled cloud securely onto the middle of the panel. LME recommends that the crinkle sheet is never left loose, only sewn into a fully closed pocket, just like the mirror.

PART 8: ASSEMBLING THE CUBE

All six sides have their own motif on this cube. You sew them together into a cube in whichever order you choose.

- 1 Lay out the six finished panels in the order you want them: the Pip side at the front, the crinkle side at the back, the mirror side and the detail side on either side, the pocket side on top, and the star side underneath.
- 2 Sew together five of the six seams with tight edging stitches or a whip stitch, right sides out, so you have an open cube with only one hole left.
- 3 Insert the six foam squares, one into each side, through the last open hole, along with a little loose stuffing in the corners for a soft feel.
- 4 Sew the last hole closed just as tightly and securely as the other five seams.
- 5 Go over all six seams once more on the outside, with tight stitches, for extra strength where little hands will pull and squeeze.

PART 9: THE TOP HANDLE

Thread a selection of round wooden beads and yarn-covered balls (sage green, cream, powder pink, light sky blue and yellow, just like on Pip's stroller toy) onto a short, sturdy cotton cord, in whatever order you like. Sew both ends of the cord securely along the top seam, between the Pip side and the pocket side, so the row of beads forms a small arch over the top, like a handle.

The bead balls are crocheted just like the balls on the pacifier clip: 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), 12 sc for 2 rounds, dec x 6 (6), stuff lightly and fasten off.

PART 10: THE CORNER RINGS AND TASSELS

Sew a wooden teething ring securely into each of the two vertical seams flanking the Pip side (the seam towards the mirror side on one side, the seam towards the detail side on the other), so the rings hang as in the reference photo. Each ring must be sewn on with several rounds of tight whip stitching, not just threaded loosely through the seam.

Make two short bead tassels: thread 2 to 3 balls/beads (for example one yarn-covered ball, one wooden bead, one yarn-covered ball) onto a short cotton cord, no more than 6 to 8 cm long, and sew the fixed attachment point securely right next to each corner ring. No loop should be loose or long enough to stretch out beyond 8 cm.

ASSEMBLY, STEP BY STEP

- 1 Crochet the six base squares and edge them all in light brown.
- 2 Crochet the Pip side, the star side, the detail side, the mirror side, the pocket side and the crinkle side, each onto its own base square.
- 3 Sew five of the seams together into an open cube, insert the foam squares and a little stuffing, and sew the last seam closed.
- 4 Attach the top handle along the top seam.
- 5 Attach the two corner rings and the two bead tassels into the seams flanking the Pip side.
- 6 Sew the crinkle sheet securely between the two clouds, and attach the finished cloud to the middle of the crinkle side.
- 7 Fasten every loose end securely on the inside of the pieces, and trim what is left.
- 8 Gently tug on every single part, ring and tassel, and press lightly on the cloud, to check that nothing comes loose, before the toy is used.

SAFETY, THE MOST IMPORTANT PAGE

MANY SMALL PARTS, ONE RULE: SEW EVERYTHING ON

This toy has more motifs and more different materials (yarn, wood, mirror, cord) than any other pattern in the Pip collection. Every single motif, every ring and every bead must be sewn on with strong, twisted cotton thread and plenty of tight stitches, going around at least twice. The mirror must always be fully enclosed in a closed pocket, never loose in the regular stuffing.

MORE IMPORTANT RULES

- Always use under adult supervision, especially the first few times, until you are confident every seam holds.
- No parts are glued. Everything is sewn on, nothing is attached with paperclips, safety pins or similar.
- Use only a baby-safe acrylic/plastic mirror, never real glass or a mirror intended for adults.
- The crinkle sheet must always be fully enclosed between the two cloud layers, never loose in the regular stuffing, and never accessible through an open seam.
- The corner rings' bead tassels must never be longer than approx. 6 to 8 cm, and must be sewn on, not just threaded loosely.
- The foam squares must always be fully enclosed inside the cube, never accessible or visible through an open seam.
- Check the toy regularly, and especially before every use: gently tug on every motif and ring, and press lightly on the cloud. Discard or repair immediately if anything is loose.
- This pattern is a guide for home use. If the finished product is sold, it must always be checked, tested and marked as required under current local safety requirements and regulations for children's products/toys, which set strict requirements specifically for toys with many small, sewn-on parts and cords.

CARE AND WASHING

Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with a little mild soap, since the cube has many sewn parts and an inner stiffening. Rinse well. Gently press out the water in a towel, do not wring. Lay flat to dry, allowing plenty of time for the inner stiffening to dry completely, and check every seam carefully before using the toy again.

CONGRATULATIONS, THE ACTIVITY CUBE IS DONE!

Now you have crocheted the most detailed pattern in the whole Pip collection. Well done, and happy exploring!

THE REST OF THE LME BABY COLLECTION

- Pip, the little hedgehog
- Pip's pacifier clip
- Pip's rattle
- Pip's stroller toy
- Pip's ballerina shoes with a spike stripe

COPYRIGHT

(c) Renate Dahl, Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is a fully original LME design. You are welcome to sell finished pieces you make from this pattern, on a small personal scale, provided the finished product is checked against current safety requirements. The pattern itself, its text and images, may not be shared, copied or resold.

By Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers · lmexplorers.com